



Learning by example

It's good to know lots of good songs and tunes, in different styles and from different periods. Some of the best tunes have a simplicity about them, as if they were there all along, waiting to be discovered.

▽ "Fuji-san"

Widely sung in Japanese schools, this is the first half of a song published in 1911. It celebrates the beauty of Mount Fuji.

A - ta-ma o ku - mo - no u - e ni da - shi

shi - ho - o no ya - ma o mi - o - ro - shi - te

The melody reaches its climax here.

▽ "Vltava"

This melody by the Czech composer Smetana (1824–84) portrays the gathering momentum of the river that flows through the Czech capital, Prague.

p dolce. *sf* *p*

dim. *p*

The melody is marked with articulations and dynamics to bring out its character.

▽ Mozart, *Clarinet Quintet*

This piece ends with a joyous dancing tune. Mozart wrote this, and the equally well-loved *Clarinet Concerto*, for the clarinetist Anton Stadler, whose playing inspired him.

p *tr*

tr

The staccato dots add sparkle to these repeated notes.